

Kidney Venture

For those who have chronic kidney disease, here's help: Nephrolife Care of Bangalore, a unique renal superspecialty spread over 8,000 sq ft with top-of-the-line equipment, and machine networking (all dialysis data captured in real time). Services include consultation, diagnostic and OT facilities, psychological services and lifestyle management for patients and families. There are 25,000-30,000 cases of chronic renal failure every year in India, but less than 2 per cent have access to proper treatment.

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MILLION INDIANS ARE DIABETIC, THE HIGHEST NUMBER IN ANY COUNTRY.

Prevent It

The Public Health Foundation of India in collaboration with Emory University, All India Institute of Medical Sciences and Madras Diabetes Research Foundation is launching a Centre of Excellence for the Prevention and Control of Cardio-Metabolic Diseases in South Asia at Gurgaon this week.

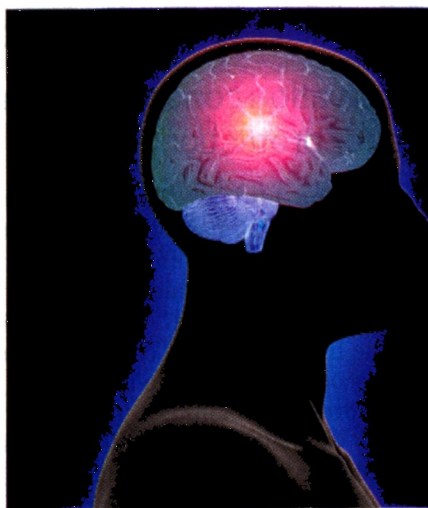


Artificial Night Lights Raise Cancer Risk

Night birds, beware! Countries that are most illuminated with artificial lights at night have the highest incidences of cancer, report scientists from Israel and the UK. When a light is turned on at night, it triggers an "over-expression" of cells linked to the formation of cancer, they say. That's because melatonin (the hormone that regulates other hormones and the body's sensitive wake-and-sleep mechanism) is stimulated by darkness and suppressed by light. Melatonin is a powerful antioxidant whose diminished supply leads to cancer. Those with high levels of melatonin have a lower risk of cancer.

Brown Rice is Better

What explains the surge in heart disease and diabetes in India in the last two decades? Blame it all on excess refined grain (polished white rice) intake which is the staple in urban India and provides the bulk of calories, unlike in the West, reports the *Indian J Med Res*. Moreover, scientists say, those who eat more rice, eat less of virtually all other foods—legumes, tubers, fruits, vegetables and dairy products. Higher fruit and vegetable intake is known to be protective against CVD and diabetes, although 91 per cent of the population in India consumes less than WHO-recommended levels. Researchers suggest replacing refined polished grains with brown or minimally polished varieties to reduce the risk of a type 2 diabetes/CVD epidemic in India.



If you thought Attention Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder (ADHD) affects just children, think again. Increasingly, the syndrome is being recognised and treated in adults as well.

Although the exact prevalence in adults is unknown, epidemiological studies so far reveal that the condition probably exists in about 2-4 per cent of adults globally. If you notice consistent inattentiveness, impulsiveness, difficulty in getting work done, procrastination or lack of discipline in an adult over time, you could be at work.

■ Compiled by **Damayanti Datta**